Voices Past and Present – First impressions

E2–E3 • Adjectives • Teacher notes & answer key (do not print for students)

A- made by Atin

Lesson at a glance

Level: E2–E3 (L1 extension). **Time:** about 2½ hours (whole film first, then clips). **Aim:** understand short clips; describe places and feelings with adjectives and very / really / absolutely.

Film: Voices Past and Present (Child Migrant Stories, 11 min) – youtube.com/watch?v=cjF3FI1ngtY. Use this version – it has English subtitles. (The newer 4K version has none.) Short stories from people who came to East London as children, 1920s to today.

Clips: 1 = 4:28–5:14 (first impressions: religions, winter 1964, snow) 2 = 5:14–6:10 (Manuhar – dream and reality) 3 = 8:31–10:05 (what is home? L1 only). Play each twice.

People in the film: Henry – El Salvador, 17, 1977 • Marie Lyse – Rwanda, 12, 1994 • Max – Ireland, 12, 1927/28 • Duncan – India, 8, 1956 • Manzila – Bangladesh, 13, 1972 • Manuhar – Bangladesh, early 1970s. Others from Jamaica, Turkey, Poland, Brazil, Somalia.

Sensitivity: the opening minutes mention killing and war. Start clips at the times given. Task 6 can be about the first day at college.

Stages

Time	Stage	What to do	Slide / WS
10	Settle in	Warmer on screen: one word for London. Late arrivals start WS Task 1.	S2
10	Lead-in	Who are the people in the film? Countries on screen. Which countries are near yours?	S3
10	Key words	WS Task 1 in pairs. Check.	S4–5 / T1
20	Whole film	Read the gist questions (WS Task 2) first. Watch the whole film with subtitles. Check answers.	S6–7 / T2
5	Discussion	Pairs: How did you feel? What surprised you? What would you ask the people in the film?	S7
10	Clip 1	Read T/F first. Play twice. Check.	S8, S10 / T3
15	Clip 2	Play twice. Check. Ask: Was London like your dream?	S9, S10 / T4
15	Grammar	Good/bad adjectives. very + normal, absolutely + strong, really + both. Drill with gestures.	S11–12
15	Practice	WS Task 5. E2: Part A + Part B 1–3. E3: all. Check.	S13 / T5
10	Writing	WS Task 6 – model on S14.	S14 / T6
10	Speaking	WS Task 7 in pairs. Feedback: most common first impression?	T7
20	Games	Hangman paragraph, then Who Wants to Be a Millionaire? in teams (buttons on S15). Kahoot if time.	S15
–	Extension	L1: clip 3 + letter home from Manuhar.	S16

Differentiation

Weaker (E2): Task 5 Part A + Part B 1–3; frame on S14. Stronger (E3): add a reason (because …). L1: extension letter with strong adjectives.

Answer key

Task 1: 1 c 2 e 3 d 4 f 5 a 6 b

Task 2: a A b B c A d A

Task 3: a T b F (a very cold winter) c T d F (they were happy – they made five snowmen)

Task 4: a A b fantastic, beautiful, colourful c B

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Task 5A: good – fantastic, beautiful, exciting, colourful, wonderful; bad – cold, dirty, terrible, boring, freezing (accept cold/freezing as good if learners like the cold!)

Task 5B: 1 very 2 absolutely 3 absolutely 4 very 5 very 6 absolutely (really is correct in all six)

Clip 2 – what Manuhar says (if the video fails)

"London was something very exciting, because I read a book called London at Night, and it was very, very fascinating. I first arrived in the airport. It was fantastic. Very nice. It is like heaven. So beautiful. So many lights. It was New Year's Day. It was colourful everywhere. … But when I came here, to the actual place where I am going to live, I said, 'Oh my God, this is even worse than some places in Bangladesh.' I could see the difference between the dream and reality."

Games (buttons on slide 13)

Millionaire: https://atinwix.github.io/esol/games/millionaire-quiz.html?set=film-vpp

Hangman paragraph:

Many children came to London from other countries. Some came because of war, and some came to find work. One person arrived in the winter of 1964. It was very cold, and there were thirteen blankets on the bed! Manuhar from Bangladesh thought London was fantastic. The airport was beautiful and colourful. But his new home was terrible. Today, Henry from El Salvador says that Hackney is his home.

https://atinwix.github.io/Hangman-Paragraphs-Game/?p=TWFueSBjaGlsZHJlbiBjYW1lIHRvIExvbmRvbiBmcm9tIG90aGVyIGNvdW50cmllcy4gU29tZSBjYW1lIGJlY2F1c2Ugb2Ygd2FyLCBhbmQgc29tZSBjYW1lIHRvIGZpbmQgd29yay4gT25lIHBlcnNvbiBhcnJpdmVkIGluIHRoZSB3aW50ZXIgb2YgMTk2NC4gSXQgd2FzIHZlcnkgY29sZCwgYW5kIHRoZXJlIHdlcmUgdGhpcnRlZW4gYmxhbmtldHMgb24gdGhlIGJlZCEgTWFudWhhciBmcm9tIEJhbmdsYWRlc2ggdGhvdWdodCBMb25kb24gd2FzIGZhbnRhc3RpYy4gVGhlIGFpcnBvcnQgd2FzIGJlYXV0aWZ1bCBhbmQgY29sb3VyZnVsLiBCdXQgaGlzIG5ldyBob21lIHdhcyB0ZXJyaWJsZS4gVG9kYXksIEhlbnJ5IGZyb20gRWwgU2FsdmFkb3Igc2F5cyB0aGF0IEhhY2tuZXkgaXMgaGlzIGhvbWUu

Record of Work

Date: ____ | Teacher: Atin | Activities: Film 'Voices Past and Present' – key words; clip T/F and questions; adjectives good/bad + very/really/absolutely; writing first impressions; pair speaking; Hangman paragraph; Millionaire quiz | Notes: